IDEATION PHASE

DEFINE THE PROBLEM STATEMENTS

Date	21 October 2026
Project Type	
Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement Template

The Customer Problem Statement is used to understand the difficulties experienced by people who report, assign, investigate, and resolve IT incidents. Rather than beginning with a technical solution, the problem is described from the customer's point of view: who is affected, what they need to accomplish, what gets in their way, why the difficulty occurs, and how it affects their experience.

Project Context

An incident may begin when a user reports an issue such as being unable to connect to a corporate VPN. The incident then needs to be recorded, classified, prioritized, assigned to an appropriate support group, investigated, and resolved. During this lifecycle, support staff may need relevant knowledge articles, clear work notes, cause and resolution details, and visibility into related records such as change requests, child incidents, and service-level agreements (SLAs). If these activities are not handled consistently, information can be missed, ownership may be unclear, resolution work can be repeated, and progress may be difficult to track. These are problem areas considered by this project, not claims about a particular organization's measured performance.

Customer Problem Statement Format

Each statement follows the customer-centered format: "I am (Customer) -> I'm trying to -> But -> Because -> Which makes me feel." The statements focus on incident-management experiences and needs, not just on the features of the proposed ServiceNow implementation.

PS-1: Reporting and classifying incidents

Problem Statement	A user needs to report an IT issue with enough detail for support staff to understand and classify it correctly.
I am (Customer)	An employee experiencing an IT service problem.
I'm trying to	Report the issue clearly and provide the information needed to begin troubleshooting.
But	I may not know which details are important, and the incident may be recorded with incomplete or inconsistent information.
Because	Different incidents require relevant classification details such as category, subcategory, urgency, service, and configuration item.
Which makes me feel	Unsure whether my problem has been understood and concerned that support may be delayed.

PS-2: Assignment and ownership

Problem Statement	A service desk agent needs incidents to reach the support group that can investigate them.
I am (Customer)	A Service Desk agent managing incoming incidents.
I'm trying to	Classify the incident, assign it to the correct group, and make the next action clear.
But	An incident may need reassignment or clarification before the right technician can start work.
Because	The issue may require specific technical expertise, and assignment details must be accurate and up to date.
Which makes me feel	Concerned about delays, unclear ownership, and extra coordination.

PS-3: Investigation and knowledge reuse

Problem Statement	A technician needs useful troubleshooting guidance and a reliable record of the steps already taken.
I am (Customer)	A Level 2 support technician investigating an escalated incident.
I'm trying to	Find relevant knowledge, understand previous actions, and resolve the issue without repeating unnecessary work.
But	Relevant guidance or previous troubleshooting details may be difficult to locate or may not be documented clearly.
Because	Knowledge articles, work notes, and incident history need to be connected to the investigation and maintained consistently.
Which makes me feel	Frustrated by repeated effort and uncertain whether all useful information has been considered.

PS-4: Resolution and related-record tracking

Problem Statement	An incident handler needs to document the outcome and keep related work traceable.
I am (Customer)	An incident owner responsible for completing the incident record.
I'm trying to	Record the cause and resolution, and track relevant change requests or child incidents when needed.
But	The final outcome and related records may be incomplete or difficult to follow if they are not updated consistently.
Because	Incident resolution can involve work across incident, change, and knowledge records, and recurring issues may require linked child incidents.
Which makes me feel	Concerned that the incident history may be incomplete and future troubleshooting may be harder.

PS-5: SLA and progress visibility

Problem Statement	A support lead needs to understand incident progress and whether service commitments are being met.
I am (Customer)	An IT support lead or incident coordinator.
I'm trying to	Monitor incident status, ownership, and applicable SLA progress so that issues receive timely attention.
But	It may be difficult to identify stalled work or review timing when status, assignment, and SLA information are not easy to view together.
Because	Incident progress depends on timely updates and accessible task, activity, and SLA records.
Which makes me feel	Concerned that delays may go unnoticed and that service performance may be difficult to assess.

Problem Statement Analysis

The statements identify related challenges across the incident lifecycle. The table below summarizes each problem area, the customer's difficulty, and the underlying need.

Problem Area	Customer Difficulty	Underlying Need
Incident reporting and classification	Users may provide incomplete details or be unsure how to describe the issue.	A clear incident record with consistent classification and relevant details.
Assignment and escalation	An incident may require reassignment or additional coordination before investigation.	Clear ownership and routing to the appropriate support group.
Knowledge and investigation	Technicians may need to search for guidance or repeat steps when history is unclear.	Accessible knowledge and well-maintained work notes and incident history.
Resolution documentation	Cause, resolution, and final actions may not be recorded consistently.	A complete and understandable resolution record.

Related records	Related change requests, child incidents, or knowledge articles may be hard to trace.	Connected records that support continuity and traceability.
SLA and progress tracking	Support staff may find it difficult to spot stalled incidents or review SLA progress.	Visible status, ownership, and applicable SLA information.

Consolidated Customer Problem Statement

Users, Service Desk agents, technicians, and support leads need a consistent and traceable way to manage an IT incident from initial reporting through resolution. When incident details, assignment, knowledge, work notes, resolution information, related records, and SLA progress are not maintained clearly, incidents can require extra coordination, repeat investigation, or become difficult to monitor. The project therefore focuses on organizing the incident lifecycle in ServiceNow so that incident handling is more structured, information is easier to follow, and the final outcome is properly documented.

Key Findings from Problem Definition

- Users need a straightforward way to report an issue and provide useful details.
- Service Desk agents need consistent classification and clear assignment to the responsible support group.
- Technicians need access to relevant knowledge and a readable history of troubleshooting actions.
- Incident owners need to document cause, resolution, and appropriate related records.
- Support leads need visibility into incident status and applicable SLA information.
- These problem areas guide the next ideation activities, including brainstorming and selecting the features that fit theproject scope.

Ideation Phase Output

This Define the Problem Statements activity identifies the main customer difficulties across the IT incident lifecycle. The statements and analysis provide a basis for brainstorming possible improvements in Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow. The project can then prioritize practical features such as consistent incident classification, support-group assignment, knowledge use, resolution documentation, related-record tracking, and SLA visibility. The document describes the intended problem areas and does not claim that every feature is configured or fully verified in the current instances